

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



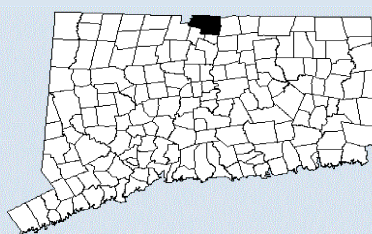
Suffield School District

Timothy Vantasel, Superintendent • 860-668-3800 • www.suffield.org/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	4
Enrollment	2,038
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,675
Total Expenditures ¹	\$41,061,845

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,027	50.4	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	91	4.5	5.2
Black or African American	73	3.6	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	182	8.9	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	31	1.5	4.7
White	1,654	81.2	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	65	3.2	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	329	16.1	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	320	15.7	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	165	16.8	30	2.9
Male	*	*	76	7.1
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	27	33.8	8	9.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	51	28.2	17	8.5
White	200	12.4	77	4.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	9	15.5	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	93	27.4	41	10.1
Students with Disabilities	80	25.3	30	7.9
District	290	14.6	106	5.0
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 312

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	146.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	20.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	23.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	44.6
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	9.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	4.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	12.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	15.0
School Nurses	5.3
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	86.1

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	1.4	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	212	98.6	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	4.5	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	7	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	*	21	100.0
White	115	94.3	154	99.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	27	84.4	32	100.0
Students with Disabilities	20	83.3	28	100.0
District	149	92.5	191	99.0
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	16	42.1
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	118	90.1
Other Health Impairment	38	71.7
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	28	96.6
District	214	77.3
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	41	2.1	2.6
Emotional Disability	16	0.8	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	131	6.8	6.4
Other Health Impairment	54	2.8	3.5
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	33	1.7	2.0
All Disabilities	292	15.1	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	14	4.8	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	13	4.5	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$27,465,804	\$13,160	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$3,453,323	\$1,704	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$598,489	\$295	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,531,522	\$756	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$2,417,668	\$1,193	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$32,035	\$16	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$3,090,998	\$1,525	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$1,672,926	\$999	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$799,080	\$394	\$213
Total	\$41,061,845	\$19,675	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$2,974,195	31.5	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,174,208	12.4	10.2
Other Salaries	\$475,266	5.0	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,091,054	11.6	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$424,102	4.5	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,531,346	26.8	22.2
Supplies	\$32,613	0.3	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$725,388	7.7	8.4
Equipment	\$7,238	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$9,435,410	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	73.3
State	19.5
Federal	3.6
Tuition & Other	3.6

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	46	78.0	46	77.4	21	78.8
Black or African American	38	59.2	38	52.7	18	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	81	66.1	81	60.9	34	67.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	13	*	13	*	6	*
White	847	71.5	848	69.7	359	72.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	50	65.4	50	65.0	13	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	978	71.3	979	68.9	427	72.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	156	63.9	157	58.9	76	63.5
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	872	72.2	872	70.4	364	73.5
Students with Disabilities	156	50.7	156	49.2	62	50.8
Students without Disabilities	872	74.6	873	72.2	378	75.2
High Needs	307	59.8	308	57.2	128	59.8
Non-High Needs	721	75.7	721	73.6	312	76.7
District	1,028	71.0	1,029	68.7	440	71.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	74.8	65.2	68.5	80.6	569	72.4
Curl Up	81.9	61.4	62.9	81.9	568	72.4
Push Up	70.3	49.6	60.8	67.4	566	62.4
Mile Run/PACER	89.0	63.6	55.6	61.8	565	68.1
All Tests - District	49.7	27.3	28.9	42.7	560	37.5
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	7	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	*
White	135	97.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	44	90.9
Students with Disabilities	24	83.3
District	165	95.8
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	135	65.5
Male	78	53.1
Non-Binary	0	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	20	50.0
White	174	62.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	24	37.5
Students with Disabilities	14	26.9
District	213	60.2
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	83.1	89.7
Male	*	89.9
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	81.8	91.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	70.0	81.8
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	81.6	89.8
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	71.0	75	47.3	50	94.6	63.9
	High Needs Students	59.8	75	39.8	50	79.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	68.7	75	45.8	50	91.6	60.2
	High Needs Students	57.2	75	38.1	50	76.2	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	71.8	75	47.8	50	95.7	61.8
	High Needs Students	59.8	75	39.9	50	79.7	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	62.3%	100%	62.3	100	62.3	58.7%
	High Needs Students	55.8%	100%	55.8	100	55.8	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	69.4%	100%	69.4	100	69.4	61.4%
	High Needs Students	66.1%	100%	66.1	100	66.1	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	69.6%	100%	34.8	50	69.6	58.9%
	Oral	60.1%	100%	30.0	50	60.1	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	14.6%	<=5%	30.7	50	61.4	17.7%
	High Needs Students	22.2%	<=5%	15.7	50	31.3	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	96.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	60.2%	75%	40.1	50	80.2	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		90.0%	94%	47.9	50	95.7	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		95.8%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		92.4%	94%	98.3	100	98.3	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		81.6%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		91.7% 37.5%	75%	25.0	50	50.0	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		48.2%	60%	40.1	50	80.3	55.0%
Accountability Index				1125.0	1450	77.6	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.8	15.2	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	73.6	57.2	16.4	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.8	15.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	92.4%	1.6%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.3
	High Needs Students	98.5
Math	All Students	99.4
	High Needs Students	98.8
Science	All Students	98.7
	High Needs Students	97.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The District Improvement Plan focuses on the school goals, Theory of Action, Strategic Operating Plan and Board of Education goals. The Board of Education uses its Strategic Plan to define its primary focus for the district as a whole. The Strategic Plan makes the important connections to the building School Improvement Plans, which ensures improvement in instructional practice, and results in improved student achievement. The District-Wide Professional Development and Evaluation Committee is leading the charge in supporting the implementation of the new evaluation plans for teachers, and also designing and developing professional development that is aligned to committee goals. The Special Education department has conducted professional development activities designated to improve special education programming and outcomes for students. Teachers collaborate with their general education colleagues to develop and refine their skills regarding the instruction of reading and math for the most challenging students. Additionally, we have provided our paraprofessionals on-going training to support their work with children. The district focuses on Tier 1 interventions, particularly in reading, developed universal screens, has progress monitoring in place, and identified grade level expectations. The district has more closely aligned the SRBI process to meeting the needs of students through intervention work. The district is implementing All Day Kindergarten for all students and provides a strong preschool opportunity for three and four year olds. Parent-school community relationships continue to be an area of focus. The engagement of the community has proven to be highly successful in deepening understanding about our purpose. The support from the town governance, community, and parents has resulted in significant changes and increased support for education and the schools. This will continue to be a priority and a necessity for us to accomplish what we have set out to achieve. Additionally, we continue to define new means of communicating with parents and the community.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Suffield Public School system remains committed to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation through local regional school and district programs. Exchange programs, inter-district partnerships with neighboring districts, as well as, participation in the Open Choice program provide opportunities to bring students and families from diverse backgrounds together in furthering the ideals of diversity, equity, and inclusion for all. Suffield Schools have been an active member of the Open Choice program for many years. As part of the Open Choice program, the district was provided access to professional learning resources and scheduled two implicit bias trainings for the 2020-2021 school year. In 2021-2022, the district began its partnership with SERC to further support our district goal of promoting diversity, equity and inclusion for all. To further engage with stakeholders on these important topics, the district created a district-level Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Council. This group, which included faculty, staff, parents and students, met five times over the course of the school year. Additionally, several DEI Council subgroups were formed, of which met multiple times to discuss grants, professional development, curriculum, and how best to communicate our efforts in creating a more welcoming and inclusive school district. In 2022-2023, the district continued its work with SERC for professional learning and community building. For professional learning, staff received training on identity, bias, and trauma informed practices.

To foster greater community involvement within each school, School Equity Teams were developed to focus on school-based efforts toward creating more welcoming and inclusive school environments. The Suffield Public Schools also utilizes Positive Behavior Support programs in all four schools. Responsive Classroom, is utilized in our elementary and middle schools, and elements of it exist at the high school level. Our staff have received a high degree of training in Responsive Classroom practices, of which have resulted in school-wide frameworks for implementation. The primary goal of this program has been to develop greater tolerance for differences.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Since the Suffield School District can be best characterized as a small district with approximately 2,100 students. Due to our size, we are able to ensure the equitable distribution of resources among our four schools to meet the needs of all learners. District committees are constructed with equitable representation from all schools for the purpose of maintaining an even proportion of resources and input required to make thoughtful decisions. Important to note, the Suffield Public Schools budget is prepared to support the district mission, vision, and district Theory of Action. This process ensures that the budget is allocated appropriately by school and by program. The resource allocation continually reflects the priorities and goals of the Board of Education, as well as, our focus on our ongoing objective of meeting the needs of all students of the Suffield Public Schools. In addition, the district is also fortunate to receive additional resources from various civic organizations, with Suffield Community Aid, PTO/PTA, Suffield Foundation for Excellent Schools, and our many boosters who further funding for district programs and services.